

Artie Ficial

Executive Director of the Meridian Museum



Artie treats the gala like a state visit and the coat check like a diplomatic incident. Polished, ambitious, and almost unnervingly composed, Artie has spent the last six years turning the Meridian from a respected regional institution into a museum that expects to be mentioned in the same sentence as the Met.

- Works closely with Claire O'Scuro. Claire keeps asking why the exhibition needs quite so much theatre.
- Relies on Monet Bags for the budget and Sue Venir for donor agreements.
- Trusts Brie DeVivre to handle the donors when Artie gets pulled into a crisis.

ACTING TIPS

Diplomatic under pressure; image-conscious; dryly funny; allergic to public chaos. Play him as someone who is always hosting, even when he is not technically the host.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Black tie or an immaculate dark suit; a very official-looking gala program.

Claire O'Scuro

Chief Curator of World Cultures



Claire can identify a fifteenth-century glaze at twenty paces and a crooked label from the parking lot. Claire is the intellectual engine behind Treasures of the World: brilliant, exacting, and visibly pained by sloppy labels, bad lighting, and people who call every old object an 'artifact.' She has spent years building the Meridian's scholarly reputation and knows the exhibition better than anyone alive.

- Works alongside Artie Ficial. They usually agree on the collection and argue about the gala.
- Mentors Reed DeLabel, who still sends draft labels for approval.
- Consults Chip Patina and Dr. Art E. Fact when an object needs closer examination.

ACTING TIPS

Controlled, observant, skeptical, extremely competitive. You do not need to be loud; a raised eyebrow can do half the work.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Elegant gallery-black with one distinctive art-history touch: sculptural jewelry, silk scarf, statement earrings, or beautifully severe glasses.

Hugh Bidder

International Art Dealer & Collector Liaison



Hugh insists everything is priceless, right up until he names a price. Hugh is the person wealthy collectors call when they want something no one else seems able to find.

- Buys art for Elon Mosaic. Elon likes to pretend he found it himself. Hugh doesn't mind.
- Penny Pincher asks Hugh for auction previews, then argues with every estimate. He hates dealing with her.
- Keeps offering to represent Vincent Van Faux. Vincent wants to discuss the commission before the paintings.

ACTING TIPS

Smooth, suave, sociable, opportunistic, impossible to embarrass. Treat every conversation like a deal that has not yet revealed itself. You're the coolest guy in the room and you know it.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Fashion-forward dinner jacket or sharp suit, polished shoes, expensive-looking watch (real or fake), pocket square.

Monet Bags

Chief Financial Officer of the Meridian Museum



Monet can locate a missing cent faster than anyone can locate the missing antiquity. Monet can tell you exactly how much tonight's floral installation cost, which donor paid for it, and which line item everyone is pretending it came from.

- Works with Artie Ficial and Sue Venir on museum budgets and donor agreements.
- Checks Brie DeVivre's catering bills. Brie needs to explain every extra charge.
- Elon Mosaic keeps suggesting new museum technology. Monet keeps asking who will pay for it.

ACTING TIPS

Quick, pragmatic, wry, unimpressed by grandeur for grandeur's sake. You notice costs other people pretend not to see. You're not afraid to spend money as long as it's a wise investment.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Modern cocktail attire: sleek, practical, expensive-looking without being flashy. Effortlessly elegant.

Chip Patina

Chief Conservator



Chip considers a fingerprint on a display case a personal attack. Chip is responsible for keeping centuries-old objects safe from humidity, fingerprints, gravity, and other people. He is the bedrock of this museum and he knows it.

- Works with Claire O'Scuro on the care and display of the collection.
- Argues with Dr. Art E. Fact about what the physical evidence can actually prove.
- Advises Elle Loominate on displaying fragile textiles. Elle listens, then asks for a less ugly support.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, meticulous, slightly territorial. You care more about what is best for this institution than what is socially convenient.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Dark suit or smart workwear made gala-appropriate; rolled sleeves under jacket, conservator gloves tucked into a pocket, loupe or small brush as a prop.

Dada DiCapo

Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity



Dada describes standing still as an endurance piece and invoices accordingly. Dada makes expensive people uncomfortable in aesthetically impeccable ways. She is the embodiment of contemporary art.

- Went to art school with Vincent Van Faux. They still remember each other's worst work.
- Elle Loominate has secretly helped build several of Dada's installations.
- Has made commissioned work for Tess Tament. Tess still asks whether one piece is meant to make that noise.

ACTING TIPS

Confident, theatrical, mischievous, intelligent. Commit to bits, but never let the joke make you foolish.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

High-fashion black tie with one strange choice: opera gloves, sculptural headpiece, monochrome outfit, dramatic makeup, oversized flower, etc. Anything Lady Gaga would wear.

Vincent Van Faux

Celebrated Contemporary Painter



Vincent believes even his shopping lists belong in a documentary. He is truly a genius of the visual arts. Vincent became famous young and has been trying ever since to convince people that this is not the same thing as becoming famous accidentally.

- Went to art school with Dada DiCapo. Dada enjoys reminding Vincent of this in front of collectors.
- Hugh Bidder wants to represent Vincent. Vincent has yet to approve Hugh's percentage.
- Penny Pincher keeps showing Vincent photos of paintings and asking what they are worth. He's not interested.

ACTING TIPS

Warm, competitive, mercurial, self-aware enough to joke about his ego but not enough to lose it.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Black tie with artist flair: velvet jacket, open collar, paint-spattered vintage shoes, dramatic ring, scarf, or deliberately imperfect formalwear. Paintbrush would be a good prop.

Sue Venir

Cultural Property Attorney



Sue corrects the fine print on dinner menus. Sue is the lawyer museums call when an object has three owners, four countries, six contradictory export documents, and one increasingly angry newspaper.

- Works with Artie Ficial and Monet Bags on museum contracts.
- Has argued opposite sides of restitution cases with Mona Lott. They're ruthless opponents but still besties.
- Dr. Art E. Fact supplies expert opinions for Sue's cases. Sue usually asks for a shorter version.

ACTING TIPS

A lawyer with sass: precise, formidable, patient, amused by sloppy certainty. Ask pointed questions and answer only the question actually asked.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Structured formalwear, crisp lines, minimal jewelry, immaculate folder or document case.

Dr. Art E. Fact

Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar



Art has never met a footnote he could not lengthen. Art has built a career tracing the lives of objects through wars, estates, auctions, private collections, and suspicious gaps in paperwork.

- Supervises Reed DeLabel's doctoral research and sends drafts back covered in notes.
- Secretly infatuated with the enigmatic energy of Dada DiCapo. Will she notice him?
- Trusts only Chip Patina to say when the physical evidence contradicts Art's theory.

ACTING TIPS

Intense, professorial, curious, occasionally pedantic, sincerely excited by evidence.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Professor at a donor gala: dark suit, tweed or textured jacket, distinctive glasses, scholarly scarf, pocket notebook.

Tess Tament

Philanthropist & Heir to the Larceny Family Fortune



Tess speaks fluent inheritance and has strong opinions about the seating plan. Tess is the only member of the Larceny dynasty who can attend an arts gala without immediately being asked for a check, mostly because everyone genuinely appreciates her opinion on culture.

- Knows Hugh Bidder from the collector circuit. Her crush on him is the only thing capable of flustering her.
- Has commissioned work from Dada DiCapo and is still explaining one of the pieces to visitors.
- Asks Mona Lott which international exhibitions might need a generous sponsor.

ACTING TIPS

Composed, witty, guarded, generous when she chooses. You grew up around power and recognize its rituals instantly.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Modern gala glamour: elegant cocktail dress, statement jewelry, designer-looking clutch, effortless rather than ostentatious.

Barb Dwyer

Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator



Barb has already assessed which guests could fit through the air vents. Barb spent years in the CIA investigating stolen art before discovering that museums contain nearly as much intrigue with better climate control.

- Coordinates museum security with Artie Ficial and Chip Patina.
- Paige Turner keeps requesting access Barb has already refused.
- Makes Brie DeVivre revise the service routes. Brie would like one final version.

ACTING TIPS

Low-key, skeptical, dry, watchful. Ask where people were and remember their answers.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Dark suit, discreet earpiece prop if desired, security-style watch, small notebook.

Paige Turner

Investigative Arts Journalist



Paige asks innocent questions with a recorder visibly running. Her journalistic integrity is unmatched. Paige covers the art world for the Times of Tulsa the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees to keep silent.

- Keeps asking Barb Dwyer for access to museum records. Barb keeps asking what the story is about.
- Sue Venir has threatened to quote Paige's own articles back to her in court.
- Calls Reed DeLabel to check dates and catalogue references. Reed is delighted when a correction makes it into print.

ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Cocktail attire with practical reporter touches: blazer, notebook, pen, compact camera if desired.

Frank Lloyd Wrong

Exhibition Architect & Designer



Frank considers doors a regrettable compromise in an otherwise excellent wall. Frank designed the physical experience of Treasures of the World: every wall angle, sight line, spotlight, pedestal, and dramatic reveal.

- Chip Patina can veto Frank's display designs. Frank tends to take the veto personally.
- Elle Loominate has worked on Frank's exhibition spaces. They vehemently disagree about how much room a textile needs.
- Dada DiCapo once described one of Frank's galleries as "an expensive corridor." Frank remembers the review.

ACTING TIPS

Aesthetic, controlled, mildly pretentious in a lovable way, easily offended by bad placement rather than bad manners.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Architectural formalwear: monochrome suit, turtleneck with jacket, sharply cut black attire, interesting glasses, rolled floor plans or a small laser measure prop.

Mona Lott

International Cultural Heritage Ambassador



Mona can turn a simple disagreement about a bowl into an international event. Mona moves between embassies, museums, ministries, and negotiation tables. Where everyone insists the issue is 'purely cultural,' Mona shows up with three lawyers and a list of demands.

- Has a long professional friendship with Sue Venir. Their arguments sometimes continue through dinner.
- Debates restitution policy with Dr. Art E. Fact, who usually brings reading material.
- Secretly wants to fool Tess Tament into paying millions for cheap bead necklaces from China.

ACTING TIPS

Elegant, diplomatic, strategic, warm until precision is required. You can disagree without ever sounding flustered.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Refined diplomatic formalwear; jewel tones, elegant suit or dress, subtle cultural or heritage-inspired accessory worn respectfully.

Elon Mosaic

Tech Founder, Collector & Museum Patron



Elon keeps suggesting that the museum should pivot to subscription antiquities. Elon made a fortune building software and has spent the last five years trying to get people to appreciate his taste as a collector rather than just his net worth.

- Buys everything through Hugh Bidder but pretends he found the art himself.
- Knows Tess Tament from the collector circuit. They compare acquisitions whenever they meet.
- Keeps pitching museum technology to Monet Bags. Monet asks for the price before the demonstration.

ACTING TIPS

Energetic, socially confident, competitive, eager to demonstrate taste without looking eager.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Modern black tie with tech-founder looseness: excellent jacket, minimal sneakers or polished shoes, unusual watch, bold glasses, goofy hairstyle.

Anya Tique

Founding Curator Emerita



Anya remembers when the museum was two rooms and an argument. Anya helped build the Meridian's collection when the museum had more ambition than money and fewer committees than fire extinguishers.

- Hired Artie Ficial early in his career.
- Trusts Chip Patina and Anne E. Dote.
- Has known Tess Tament since Tess was a child.

ACTING TIPS

Imperious, funny, observant, utterly unimpressed by status. Age gives you permission to say what everyone else edits.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Old-school gala elegance: brooch, gloves, shawl, pearls, cane if desired, formal suit or dress with unmistakable presence.

Saul D. Bid

Chairman of Gavel & Rowe Auction House



Saul cannot ask someone to pass the salt without opening bidding. Saul has sold paintings, antiques, estates, scandals, and at least one chair that required its own insurance rider.

- Longtime professional rival of Hugh Bidder.

ACTING TIPS

Old-school charm, status-aware, patient, competitive. Speak as if the room has already agreed you belong in it.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Classic tuxedo or formal dark suit, silk pocket square, signet ring, reading glasses, optional miniature auction gavel.

Elle Loominate

Textile Artist & Designer



Elle has identified every fabric in the room, including the suspiciously shiny tuxedo. Elle turns weaving, embroidery, salvage fabric, and obsessive handwork into installations that critics call intimate and collectors call surprisingly difficult to ship.

- Has helped Dada DiCapo build several installations.
- Asks Chip Patina how to display fragile textiles without making the supports the main attraction.
- Has worked in Frank Lloyd Wrong's exhibition spaces. Frank's empty walls look like opportunities to Elle.

ACTING TIPS

Creative, grounded, quietly funny, detail-oriented. You notice what people wear and how things are made.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Formal outfit with texture: embroidered jacket, woven scarf, textile jewelry, patterned dress, unusual fabric.

Reed DeLabel

Doctoral Fellow in Art History



Reed reads every label aloud, including the exit sign. Reed is the youngest scholar attached to the exhibition and has been trying very hard to behave like this is normal.

- Dr. Art E. Fact supervises Reed's doctorate and rarely returns a clean draft.
- Gets informal guidance from Claire O'Scuro on exhibition labels and curatorial work.
- Checks dates and catalogue references for Paige Turner. Reed saves any article that includes a correction.

ACTING TIPS

Eager, cerebral, anxious in a useful way, unexpectedly bold when the evidence is on your side.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Best-suit energy: formal but slightly less effortless than the veterans.

Al Baster

Sculptor & Public-Art Star



Al considers a pedestal a sculpture that has given up on itself. Al makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane.

- Frank Lloyd Wrong designed the entrance around Al's sculpture. They still disagree about which one visitors came to see.
- Competes with Vincent Van Faux for commissions. Al keeps calculating how many paintings weigh as much as one sculpture.
- Dada DiCapo once performed inside one of Al's sculptures. Al found out from the photographs.

ACTING TIPS

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Bold formalwear, chunky ring, sculptural accessories, dark shirt with jacket, perhaps a dust-marked work boot paired with gala clothes.

Ella Gance

Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture



Ella dresses as though the society pages arrive before the guests. Ella has excellent taste, excellent photographers, and excellent instincts about which artists will become impossible to buy next year.

- Collects work by Vincent Van Faux and Elle Loominate.
- Competes socially and at auction with Elon Mosaic.

ACTING TIPS

Charming, strategic, stylish, lightly competitive. Compliments can be sincere and still accomplish something.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Fashion-forward gala look, statement jewelry, dramatic clutch, bold color or silhouette.

Drew Conclusions

Art Critic & Cultural Podcaster



Drew calls everything derivative, especially things he likes. Drew can make a museum director nervous with a headline and an artist furious with a compliment.

- Friendly rival of Paige Turner.
- Has reviewed Vincent Van Faux, Dada DiCapo, Al Baster, and Elle Loominate.
- Elon Mosaic remembers an especially brutal line about his collection.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, perceptive, skeptical, socially nimble. Deliver observations as if they occurred to you three minutes before everyone else.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Smart, artsy formalwear: black with one eccentric element, distinctive glasses, scarf, vintage jacket, notebook.

Brie DeVivre

Head Caterer & Hospitality Director



Brie has planned a cheese course more carefully than most people plan a wedding. Brie runs high-end events with the serene expression of a person mentally tracking forty-seven moving parts.

- Goes over catering costs with Monet Bags. Brie keeps the receipts. He knows Monet is addicted to expensive cheddar.
- Barb Dwyer keeps revising the service routes. Brie wants the staff to have one usable plan. Brie knows Barb is lactose intolerant.
- Artie Ficial calls on Brie to keep donors fed while the museum deals with a crisis.

ACTING TIPS

Competent, sociable, quietly authoritative, hard to rattle. You see the room from the service side. You also know everyone's secrets!

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Sharp black suit or upscale catering uniform, tie or bow tie, folded service towel, small order pad.

Cary Crates

Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist



Cary knows which crate holds a masterpiece and which one holds the extension cords. Cary is the person trusted to move objects worth more than the building without dropping either.

- Works daily with Chip Patina.
- Has developed mutual respect with Frank Lloyd Wrong despite arguing about impossible installation drawings.
- Al Baster likes Cary because Cary actually knows how heavy sculpture is.

ACTING TIPS

Grounded, competent, laconic, surprisingly funny when you choose to speak.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Clean dark workwear dressed up for a gala: black trousers, sturdy shoes, smart shirt/jacket, work gloves tucked in pocket, measuring tape prop.

Anne E. Dote

Director of Education & Docent Programs



Anne can make a school group care about a pot shard. Tonight's donors are proving harder.

- Coaches Reed DeLabel through gallery tours. Reed keeps adding footnotes to the children's handouts.
- Turns Claire O'Scuro's research into tours people can follow. Claire keeps restoring the difficult words.
- Invites Justin Tyme to speak about Tulsa history. She now reviews his slides before inviting donors.

ACTING TIPS

Engaging, practical, empathetic, irreverent about institutional pomp.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Colorful cocktail attire or polished museum-professional look, comfortable shoes, fun brooch or earrings, optional stack of tour cards.

Faye Stop

Gala Photographer & Editorial Portraitist



Faye will ask you to move half an inch until the end of time. Faye photographs artists, collectors, and public figures for magazines that describe parties like tonight as 'intimate' despite inviting two hundred people.

- Has photographed several investigations for Paige Turner.
- Dada DiCapo loves Faye's work because Faye does not overdirect.

ACTING TIPS

Observant, understated, curious, visually minded. You notice who is standing with whom and what happens at the edge of a room.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Elegant all-black or dark cocktail wear, camera as the key prop if available, comfortable shoes, press-style shoulder bag.

Robin Banks

Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer



Robin has brought a petition, spare pens and absolutely no interest in donor etiquette. Robin campaigns for museums and collectors to return contested cultural objects, publish complete provenance, and stop treating possession as the end of the conversation.

- Frequently debates Dr. Art E. Fack and Mona Lott on strategy.
- Barb Dwyer has removed Robin from a museum event before; both remember it.
- Anne E. Dote quietly agrees with more of Robin's critique than museum leadership suspects.

ACTING TIPS

Focused, bold, principled, socially savvy. Challenge people without turning every conversation into a speech.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Smart gala attire with activist edge: bold pin, statement scarf, printed tote, elegant suit or dress.

Penny Pincher

Eccentric Private Collector



Penny is convinced that every museum object would look better in her hallway. Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did.

- Asks Hugh Bidder for auction previews and always disputes his estimates.
- Shows Vincent Van Faux photos of paintings and asks for a free valuation.
- Has compared auction finds with Tess Tament. Penny prefers a bargain Tess has overlooked.

ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Eclectic formalwear: vintage jewelry, dramatic brooches, velvet, patterned jacket, gloves, small opera glasses or fan.

Justin Tyme

Independent Blogger & Local Truthstorian



Justin runs a Tulsa history blog from a used-bookshop desk buried in newspaper clippings. He tracks old property deeds, vanished music venues, and the names donors would rather leave off the plaque. Ask him about a grand local family and he may reach for a folder instead of a compliment.

- Paige Turner considers Justin useful when she needs Tulsa context and dangerous when he starts telling stories.
- Gives local-history talks for Anne E. Dote. She keeps asking him to finish before the museum closes.
- Has been digging into the museum's early property records. Artie Ficial keeps offering him the official anniversary brochure.

ACTING TIPS

Sociable, stubborn, and easily sidetracked by a good lead. Ask who owned the building before the museum arrived. Treat an old clipping like something worth showing the person beside you.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Rumpled blazer over a patterned shirt, comfortable boots, notebook, reading glasses, and a battered folder of old newspaper clippings.

Minnie Malist

Gala Event Designer & Creative Producer



Minnie considers restrained lighting a cry for help. Minnie creates the visual spectacle around events like tonight: flowers, lighting, table styling, entrances, reveals, and the precise moment everyone is supposed to gasp.

- Works constantly with Frank Lloyd Wrong, who removes half of Minnie's ideas.
- Brie DeVivre is Minnie's favorite partner in event logistics.
- Monet Bags is the person who asks what Minnie's ideas cost.

ACTING TIPS

Energetic, aesthetic, affectionate, slightly chaotic but highly competent. You notice atmosphere first.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Creative formalwear: floral pin, velvet jacket, unusual bow tie, colorful suit, statement glasses.